



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Prayer, Faith & Gratitude Study Workbook

Learning to Talk Honestly With God and Live Thankfully - For Ages
13-19

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Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class



HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Prayer can feel awkward, boring, or pointless - until you understand what it actually is. This six-unit study teaches honest prayer, trusting God's answers, and a grateful heart that resists the constant discontent of comparison culture. Practical, honest, and rooted in Scripture. For ages 13 to 19.

PHILIPPIANS 4:6

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation... present your requests to God."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

What Prayer Really Is

"Lord, teach us to pray." - Luke 11:1

Unit Overview

Prayer is not a performance or a formula; it's honest conversation with a God who listens. This unit reframes prayer as relationship.

DEVOTIONAL

Talking With God

The disciples didn't ask Jesus to teach them to preach or do miracles first. They asked him to teach them to pray.

LUKE 11:1

"One day Jesus was praying in a certain place. When he finished, one of his disciples said to him, 'Lord, teach us to pray.'"

Prayer isn't reciting the right words; it's relating to a real Person who already knows and loves you.

If even Jesus needed regular prayer, we shouldn't treat it as optional or advanced.

Reflect

1. What has prayer felt like for you - duty, awkward, real, or rare?

2. What would change if you saw prayer as conversation, not performance?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, teach me to pray. I want to actually talk with you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Model for Prayer

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 6:9-13

"This, then, is how you should pray: 'Our Father in heaven, hallowed be your name, your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us today our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we also have forgiven our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. How does the prayer begin - who is addressed?

2. List the different things this prayer asks for.

3. What comes before the requests?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Model for Prayer

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Jesus start with God's name and kingdom before our needs?

2. What does this teach about prayer's priorities?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which line of this prayer do you most need to pray?

2. How could you use this as a pattern this week?

WORD STUDY

Prayer

MEANING

Communication with God - praise, thanks, confession, and requests - in an ongoing relationship.

Where It Appears**1 THESSALONIANS 5:17**

"Pray continually."

JAMES 5:16

"The prayer of a righteous person is powerful and effective."

Dig Deeper

1. What does 'pray continually' look like in a normal day?

2. What keeps you from praying more?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Prayer Life

Describe your current prayer life honestly.

What do you wish were different?

What's one small change you could make?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Does Prayer Even Do Anything?

THE QUESTION

If God already knows everything, why pray?

Think It Through**Relationship, not vending machine**

Prayer's main purpose is knowing God, not just getting things.

God invites participation

Scripture says God genuinely works through the prayers of his people.

It changes us

Prayer reshapes our desires and perspective, not just our circumstances.

Your Response

1. Which purpose of prayer surprises you most?

2. What honest question about prayer do you still have?

UNIT 2

Praying Through Honesty

"Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you." - 1 Peter 5:7

Unit Overview

God can handle your real emotions. This unit explores praying through anxiety, anger, and doubt using the raw honesty of the Psalms.

DEVOTIONAL

God Can Take It

Many teens think they have to clean themselves up before praying. The Psalms say otherwise.

PSALM 13:1

"How long, Lord? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me?"

The Bible includes prayers of grief, anger, and confusion. God isn't fragile; he invites your honesty.

Notice Psalm 13 starts with complaint and ends with trust. Honesty is often the path back to faith, not away from it.

Reflect

1. What have you felt you couldn't say to God?

2. How would it feel to bring your real emotions to him?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, thank you that you can handle my honesty. I bring you my real self.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

From Complaint to Trust

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PSALM 13:1-2, 5-6

"How long, Lord? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me? How long must I wrestle with my thoughts and day after day have sorrow in my heart?... But I trust in your unfailing love; my heart rejoices in your salvation. I will sing the Lord's praise, for he has been good to me."

Observation - What does it say?

1. How does David feel at the start?

2. What questions does he ask God?

3. Where does the psalm end up?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

From Complaint to Trust

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is it healthy that this prayer includes complaint?

2. How does David move from complaint to trust?

Application - What will I do?

1. What complaint do you need to bring honestly to God?

2. Can you also name something you still trust him for?

WORD STUDY

Lament

MEANING

An honest prayer of grief or complaint to God that still trusts him.

Where It Appears**PSALM 62:8**

"Pour out your hearts to him, for God is our refuge."

PSALM 56:8

"Record my misery; list my tears on your scroll."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is lament a form of faith, not a lack of it?

2. What do you need to lament before God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Honest Prayer

What emotions are you carrying right now?

Write them out as a prayer to God.

What can you still trust God for, even now?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Honesty with God is freeing. Discuss it together.

1. Why do we hide our real feelings from God?

2. How can lament actually strengthen faith?

3. How can this group pray honestly for each other?

UNIT 3

Faith That Trusts God's Answers

"Not my will, but yours be done." - Luke 22:42

Unit Overview

God answers prayer - sometimes yes, sometimes no, sometimes wait. This unit builds trust in God's wisdom even when answers differ from our wishes.

DEVOTIONAL

When the Answer Is No

Even Jesus prayed a prayer that God answered 'no' - for the sake of a greater 'yes.'

LUKE 22:42

"Father, if you are willing, take this cup from me; yet not my will, but yours be done."

Jesus honestly asked for another way, then surrendered to the Father's wisdom. Both parts matter.

An unanswered prayer isn't an unheard prayer. Sometimes God's 'no' protects a bigger 'yes' we can't yet see.

Reflect

1. When has God answered your prayer differently than you wanted?

2. How do you respond when the answer is 'no' or 'wait'?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me trust your wisdom even when your answer isn't what I wanted.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Ask, Seek, Knock

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 7:7-11

"Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you... Which of you, if your son asks for bread, will give him a stone? ... If you, then, though you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good gifts to those who ask him!"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What three actions does Jesus urge?

2. What comparison does he make with parents?

3. What does the Father give?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Ask, Seek, Knock

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does 'good gifts' suggest about how God answers?

2. How does a loving parent sometimes say no?

Application - What will I do?

1. What have you stopped asking God for?

2. How does trusting God as a good Father change your requests?

WORD STUDY

Trust

MEANING

Confident reliance on God's character and wisdom, even when circumstances confuse us.

Where It Appears

PROVERBS 3:5-6

"Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding."

ROMANS 8:28

"We know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is trust hardest when we don't understand?

2. Where do you need to 'lean not on your own understanding'?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Trusting the Answer

What are you praying for right now?

Could you trust God if the answer were 'no' or 'wait'?

Write a prayer of surrender like Jesus prayed.

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Pray and Trust

Faith grows as we pray and then trust. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Pray daily about one specific need this week.
- ☐ Write down how God answers over time.
- ☐ Practice adding 'your will be done' to your requests.
- ☐ Thank God for a past 'no' that turned out to be for the best.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

A Grateful Heart

"Give thanks in all circumstances." - 1 Thessalonians 5:18

Unit Overview

Gratitude reorients us from what we lack to what we've been given. This unit builds thankfulness as a discipline, not just a feeling.

DEVOTIONAL

The Antidote to Discontent

Comparison and complaint come naturally; gratitude has to be practiced. But it changes everything.

1 THESSALONIANS 5:18

"Give thanks in all circumstances; for this is God's will for you in Christ Jesus."

Notice it says 'in all circumstances,' not 'for all circumstances.' Gratitude isn't pretending everything is good; it's finding God's gifts even in hard seasons.

A grateful heart is the antidote to the constant discontent that social media feeds.

Reflect

1. What are you tempted to complain about right now?

2. What could you thank God for even in that situation?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, grow a grateful heart in me, even in hard circumstances.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Thankful Even Then

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PHILIPPIANS 4:6-7

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told not to do?

2. What are we to do instead, and with what attitude?

3. What is promised as a result?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Thankful Even Then

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Paul connect thanksgiving with anxiety?

2. How does gratitude affect worry?

Application - What will I do?

1. What anxiety do you need to turn into prayer with thanksgiving?

2. How could gratitude guard your heart this week?

WORD STUDY

Gratitude

MEANING

A thankful recognition of God's goodness and gifts, expressed to him and others.

Where It Appears**PSALM 107:1**

"Give thanks to the Lord, for he is good; his love endures forever."

HEBREWS 12:28

"Let us be thankful, and so worship God acceptably."

Dig Deeper

1. How is gratitude a choice as much as a feeling?

2. Who in your life deserves your thanks that you rarely express?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Counting Gifts

List ten things you're grateful for today.

What blessing do you usually take for granted?

Write a prayer of thanks to God.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Gratitude is countercultural. Discuss how to grow it.

1. Why is our culture so prone to discontent?

2. How does gratitude change your outlook?

3. How can this group cultivate thankfulness together?

UNIT 5

Prayer as a Daily Rhythm

"Very early in the morning... Jesus... went off to a solitary place, where he prayed."

- Mark 1:35

Unit Overview

Great prayer lives are built on small habits. This unit helps establish a sustainable, personal rhythm of prayer and Bible reading.

DEVOTIONAL

Building the Habit

Jesus, the busiest and most important person ever, still made space to pray. If he needed rhythm, so do we.

MARK 1:35

"Very early in the morning, while it was still dark, Jesus got up, left the house and went off to a solitary place, where he prayed."

Notice the intentionality: early, solitary, prioritized. Prayer didn't just happen; Jesus made room for it.

You don't need hours. You need consistency. A small daily rhythm beats occasional marathons.

Reflect

1. When and where could you realistically pray each day?

2. What usually crowds out your time with God?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me build a real, sustainable rhythm of time with you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Devoted to Prayer

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

COLOSSIANS 4:2

"Devote yourselves to prayer, being watchful and thankful."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to devote ourselves to?

2. What two attitudes accompany it?

3. What does 'devote' imply?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Devoted to Prayer

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What's the difference between occasional prayer and devotion to prayer?

2. How do watchfulness and thankfulness shape prayer?

Application - What will I do?

1. What would 'devotion' to prayer look like in your life?

2. How can you be more watchful and thankful?

WORD STUDY

Devotion

MEANING

Committed, consistent love expressed through regular time and attention.

Where It Appears

ACTS 2:42

"They devoted themselves to... prayer."

2 CORINTHIANS 11:3

"But I am afraid that... your minds may somehow be led astray from your sincere and pure devotion to Christ."

Dig Deeper

1. What does devotion to a person or goal usually require?

2. How could your devotion to Christ grow more consistent?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Rhythm

When will you spend time with God each day?

What will you do in that time (read, pray, journal)?

What obstacle will you plan around?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Seven Days of Prayer

Rhythm is built by repetition. Commit to a week.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Pray at the same time each day for seven days.
- ☐ Keep a short prayer journal each day.
- ☐ Include praise, thanks, confession, and requests.
- ☐ Note one thing God does or teaches you.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

Praying for Others and the World

"I urge... that petitions, prayers, intercession and thanksgiving be made for all people." - 1 Timothy 2:1

Unit Overview

Mature prayer looks outward. This unit moves from self-focused prayer to interceding for others, the church, and the world.

DEVOTIONAL

Beyond Myself

Prayer that only ever says 'help me' stays small. Prayer grows up when it starts carrying others.

1 TIMOTHY 2:1

"I urge, then, first of all, that petitions, prayers, intercession and thanksgiving be made for all people."

Interceding - praying for others - is one of the most loving things you can do, and one of the least visible.

As you pray for others, God often grows your compassion and softens your heart toward them.

Reflect

1. Who is God putting on your heart to pray for?

2. How might praying for others change how you feel toward them?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, grow my prayers beyond myself. Give me a heart for others and the world.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Paul's Prayer for Others

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EPHESIANS 3:16-19

"I pray that out of his glorious riches he may strengthen you with power through his Spirit in your inner being, so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. And I pray that you, being rooted and established in love, may have power... to grasp how wide and long and high and deep is the love of Christ."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Paul pray others will be strengthened with?

2. What does he pray they'll grasp?

3. Who empowers this?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Paul's Prayer for Others

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How is Paul's prayer different from just praying for people's comfort?

2. What does he most want for others?

Application - What will I do?

1. How could you pray this kind of prayer for someone?

2. Who needs you to pray for their inner strength?

WORD STUDY

Intercession

MEANING

Praying on behalf of others, standing in the gap for their needs before God.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 8:34**

"Christ Jesus... is also interceding for us."

JAMES 5:16

"Pray for each other so that you may be healed."

Dig Deeper

1. What does it mean that Jesus himself intercedes for you?

2. Who could you commit to intercede for regularly?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Prayer List

List people and situations you want to pray for.

What is the most important thing this study taught you about prayer?

Write a prayer for someone other than yourself.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

Final discussion. Prayer is meant to grow outward.

1. How can we keep prayer from becoming all about ourselves?

2. What's your plan to keep praying after this book?

3. How can this group pray for each other going forward?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

LUKE 11:1

"Luke 11:1"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Luke 11:1

Write out from memory: 1 Peter 5:7

Write out from memory: Luke 22:42

Write out from memory: 1 Thessalonians 5:18

Write out from memory: Philippians 4:6

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
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REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

How has your view of prayer changed through this study?

What prayer habit will you keep?

Write a prayer of thanks and commitment.

NOTES

Study Notes

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